NON-WSQ COURSE • C817

Gemini for Google Sheet

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

AI Trainer & Engineer

- PhD-qualified trainer specialising in AI, data and software engineering.
- Builds AI agents and Gemini and Google Workspace workflows for business teams.
- Trains professionals across Singapore on practical, project-based AI skills.
- Certifications: PMP, AWS, Microsoft, CompTIA, CKA, CKAD.



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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1. Your name, organisation and role.
2. One spreadsheet you rebuild or clean every week or month.
3. A formula, chart or report you wish someone would just build for you.
4. Whether you can see the Ask Gemini (spark) button in Google Sheets on your account.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. Set your mobile phone to silent mode.
2. Participate actively — no question is too small.
3. Mutual respect: agree to disagree.
4. One conversation at a time.
5. Be punctual; return from breaks on time.
6. Learn by doing — try every hands-on lab.

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Access Course Materials

1. Open the C817 course page or the trainer-supplied Drive folder
2. Open the courseware links for this course
3. Download the Slides, Learner Guide and Lesson Plan
4. Open the labs folder for all 12 lab folders
5. Keep the files together as you work

Course page: tertiarycourses.com.sg/gemini-for-google-sheet.html

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Lesson Plan — 1 Day, 7.5 instructional hours

Course sequence

- Topic 1: Fundamentals of Google Sheet (Labs 1–4)
- Topic 2: Data Analytics and Visualization (Labs 5–8)
- Topic 3: Interactive Dashboard (Labs 9–12)

Day format

- Daily timing
  - 9:30 am - 6:30 pm (1-hour lunch; two 15-minute tea breaks; 7.5 instructional hours)
- Instructional time
  - 7.5 hours · 12 connected labs
- Learning arc
  - Concept → demonstrate → build → verify → discuss → recap

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COURSE ROADMAP

Twelve Labs in Three Topics

Fundamentals of Google Sheet

- Lab 1: Gemini Side Panel & Summaries
- Lab 2: Data Quality Check
- Lab 3: Data Prep
- Lab 4: Formulas: VLOOKUP, COUNTIF & Nested IF

Data Analytics & Visualization

- Lab 5: Tables, Trackers & Conditional Formatting
- Lab 6: AI Function & Fill with Gemini
- Lab 7: Data Analysis & Insights
- Lab 8: Charts & Visualisation

Interactive Dashboard

- Lab 9: Dashboard KPIs & Selectors
- Lab 10: Interactive Dashboard
- Lab 11: Gems
- Lab 12: Optimisation, Reporting & Safe Sharing

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

Sheets Fundamentals

Use Gemini in Google Sheets - the side panel, actions and formula help - to summarise, quality-check and prepare HR data, and to generate, explain and fix formulas such as VLOOKUP, COUNTIF and nested IF.

2

Analytics & Visualization

Create colour-coded tables, trackers and dropdowns, extract and categorise text with the AI function, and generate data analysis, insights, pivot tables and charts with Gemini, verifying every result.

3

Interactive Dashboard

Build an interactive hiring dashboard, automate repeat screening with a custom Gem, and use Gemini's optimisation solver, reporting and sharing features responsibly.

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LEARNING APPROACH

How You'll Learn

1. Trainer demonstrates the concept
2. You build it yourself in the hands-on lab
3. Verify with the lab's 'Test it' step
4. Discuss and troubleshoot together
5. Recap against the learning outcomes

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CORE CONCEPTS

Gemini in Google Sheets for HR and Recruitment

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OVERVIEW

The Orchid Bay Scenario

1

Orchid Bay Talent Partners

A fictional Singapore recruitment and HR services firm.

2

The Q3 2026 hiring drive

8 client roles, 12 openings, 240 applications - plus 2026 year-to-date data.

3

One storyline

Raw export > clean data > screening formulas > tracker > insights > dashboard > Gem > decision.

4

Your role

Talent analyst using Gemini to screen candidates and report - and checking every number.

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TOPIC 01

Fundamentals of Google Sheet

Gemini side panel and summaries · data quality checks · data prep with Gemini actions · generating, explaining and fixing formulas (VLOOKUP, COUNTIF, nested IF)

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C817 OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Gemini drafts. Formulas prove. People decide.

Describe the task precisely, check every result against the data, and keep decisions about candidates with accountable people.

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FROM GOOGLE'S OFFICIAL GUIDE

What Gemini in Google Sheets Does - and Where You Practise It

1

Summarise and ask

Summaries and questions about your data - Labs 1, 2.

2

Perform actions

Formatting, find and replace, sort, filter, freeze, insert, delete - Labs 2, 3, 5.

3

Create formulas

Generate, explain and fix - Labs 4, 9.

4

Create tables

From scratch or from notes - Lab 5.

5

AI function

=AI and Fill with Gemini in cells - Lab 6.

6

Analysis and insights

Trends, pivot tables, Export to Docs - Lab 7.

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FROM GOOGLE'S OFFICIAL GUIDE

What Gemini in Google Sheets Does - and Where You Practise It (cont.)

7

Charts and graphs

Preview, Insert, Copy - Lab 8.

8

Gems

Custom assistants in the side panel - Lab 11.

9

Optimisation solver

Best combination under constraints - Lab 12.

10

Drive, Gmail and the web

Files, emails and search as context - Labs 7, 12.

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Key Concepts — Fundamentals of Google Sheet

1

Native Sheets first

Gemini works best on a Google Sheets file - save an .xlsx as Google Sheets first.

2

Ask, then insert

Answers stay in the side panel until you click Insert. Insert anything you want to keep.

3

Actions you approve

For edits, Gemini shows an Action preview card. You click Apply - and can Undo.

4

Name the tab and column

'Count Hired in the Stage column on Applications' beats 'analyse my data'.

5

Describe the formula

Write the rule in plain English; Gemini writes VLOOKUP, IF or COUNTIFS and explains it.

6

Check every number

Confirm Gemini's answers with your own COUNTIF, COUNTIFS or pivot-table total.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Fundamentals of Google Sheet

Labs 1–2

- **Gemini Side Panel & Summaries**
  - Open Gemini and Explore the Q3 Candidate Export
- **Data Quality Check**
  - Check the Quality of the Candidate Data with Gemini

Labs 3–4

- **Data Prep**
  - Clean and Prepare the Candidate Data with Gemini Actions
- **Formulas: VLOOKUP, COUNTIF & Nested IF**
  - Generate, Explain and Fix Screening Formulas

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What Gemini in Google Sheets Can Do

WHAT IT IS

- Google's AI built into Sheets: tables, formulas, analysis, charts and actions from plain-English prompts.

WHY IT MATTERS

- It speeds up routine spreadsheet work - but its output is a proposal until you check it.

CHECK IT

- Can you name three things Gemini can do and one it should not decide for you?

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Try It in Gemini — What Gemini in Google Sheets Can Do

ASK GEMINI

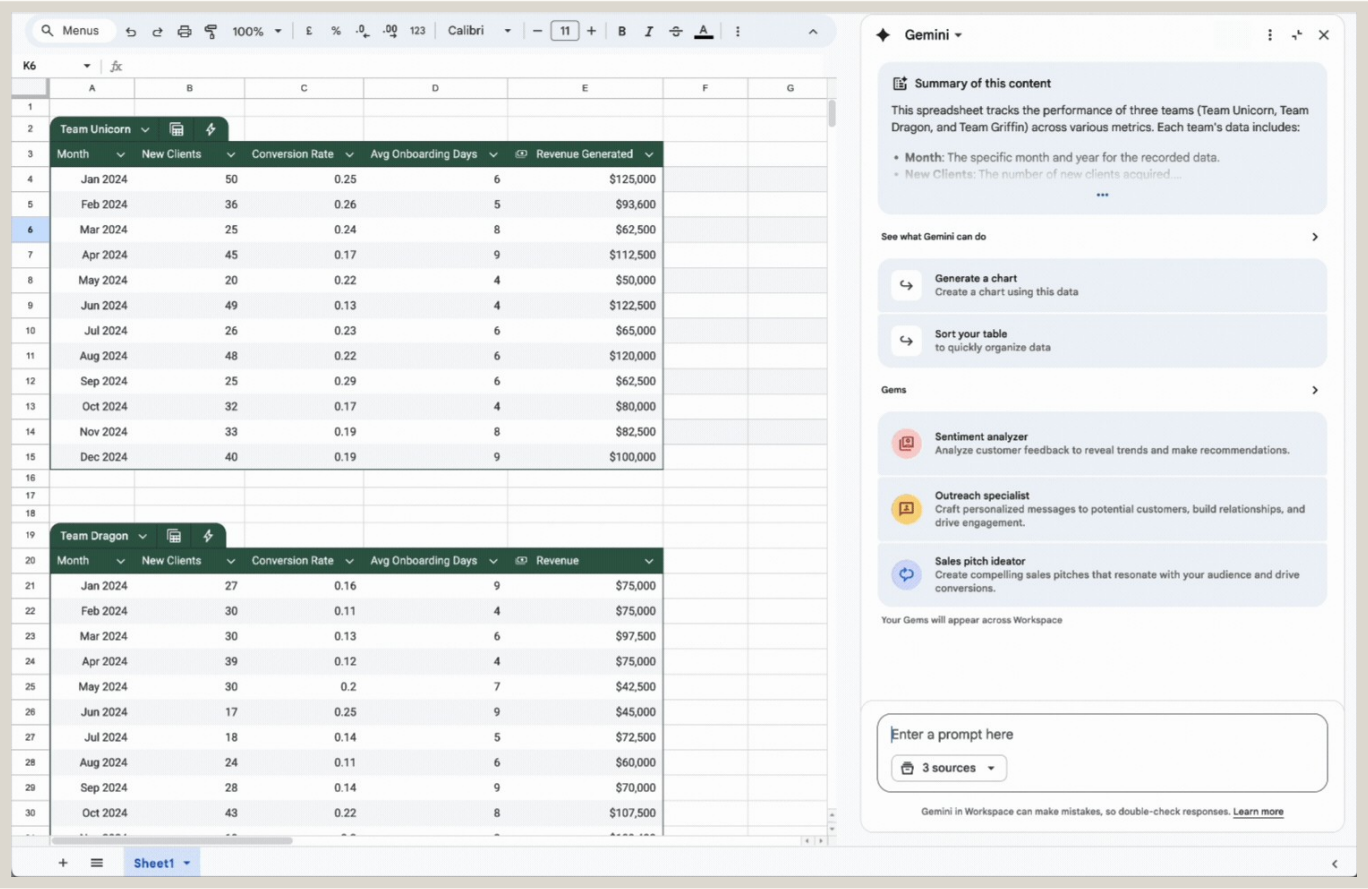
- Open a sheet > Ask Gemini (spark, top right).
- Summarize this spreadsheet.
- Which Position has the most applications?
- Shortcut: Cmd + Ctrl + N (Mac) / Ctrl + Alt + N (Windows).

THEN CHECK

- Rows and dates match the About tab.
- A COUNTIF agrees with Gemini's count.

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Gemini in Google Sheets: the Side Panel



Summary of the sheet, suggestions, Gems and the prompt box with its sources. Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

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Five Ways to Work with Gemini in Sheets

	Side panel answer	Insert	Action	=AI function	Gem
What you do	Ask a question	Ask, then click Insert	Ask, then click Apply	Type =AI(...) in a cell	Pick your Gem in the panel
Changes the sheet?	No	Yes, when you insert	Yes - Undo available	Yes, when you generate	Only if you insert
Best for	Questions, insights	Tables, formulas, charts	Formatting, pivots, sort/filter	Row-by-row text	Repeatable expert tasks
Lab	1, 7	1, 5, 8	2, 3, 5	6	11

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Prompting Gemini and the Side Panel

WHAT IT IS

- A prompt names the tab, columns, task and output. The panel adds sources, Insert, Retry, Undo and history.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Precise prompts give precise answers; history is lost on reload, so insert what matters.

CHECK IT

- Does your prompt say which tab, which columns and what the output should look like?

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Try It in Gemini — Prompting Gemini and the Side Panel

ASK GEMINI

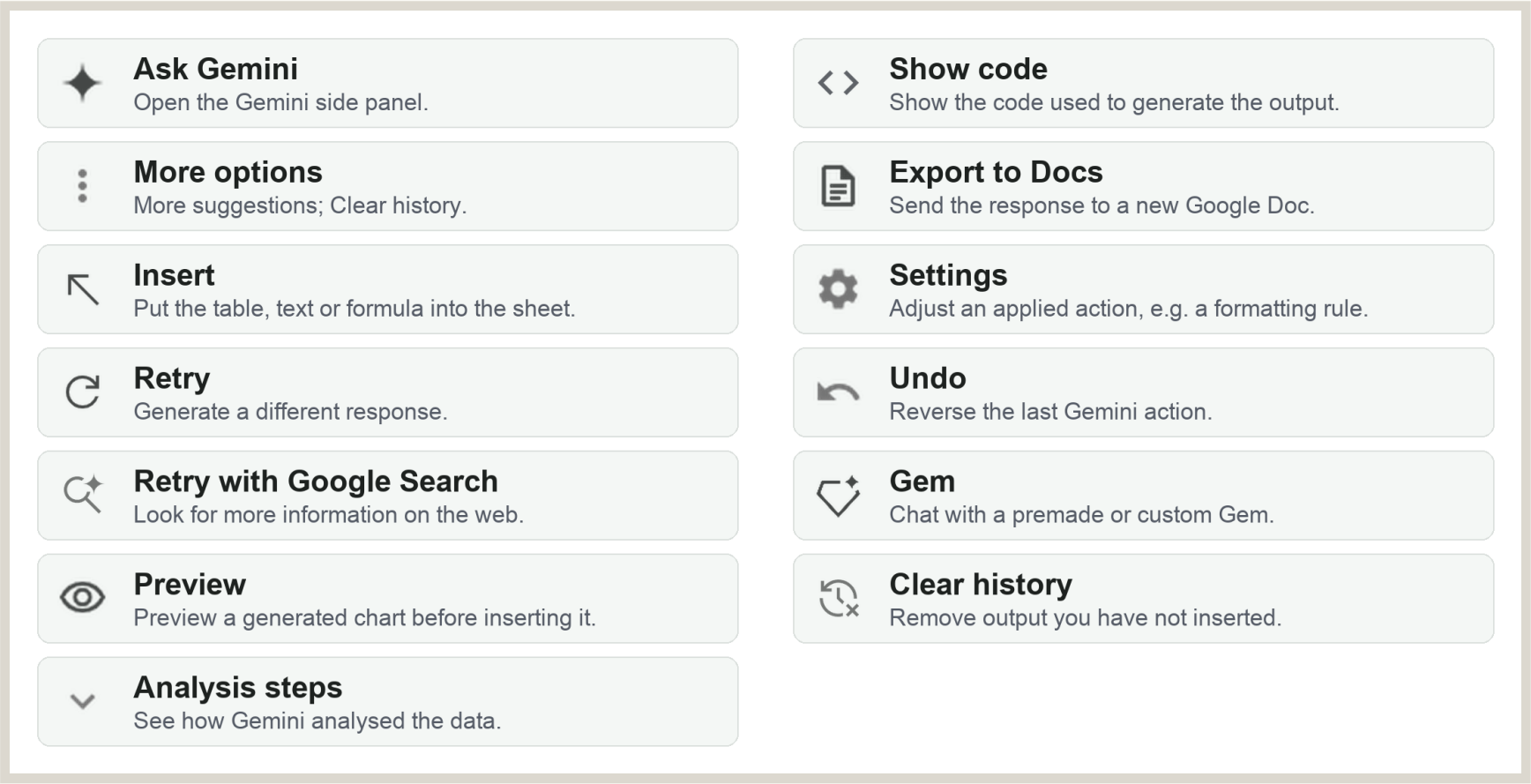
- Using the Applications and Jobs tabs, make a table of applications and Openings per Position.
- Follow-up: add Applications_per_Opening and sort high to low.
- Then click Insert.

THEN CHECK

- The table has 8 positions.
- It survives a page reload.

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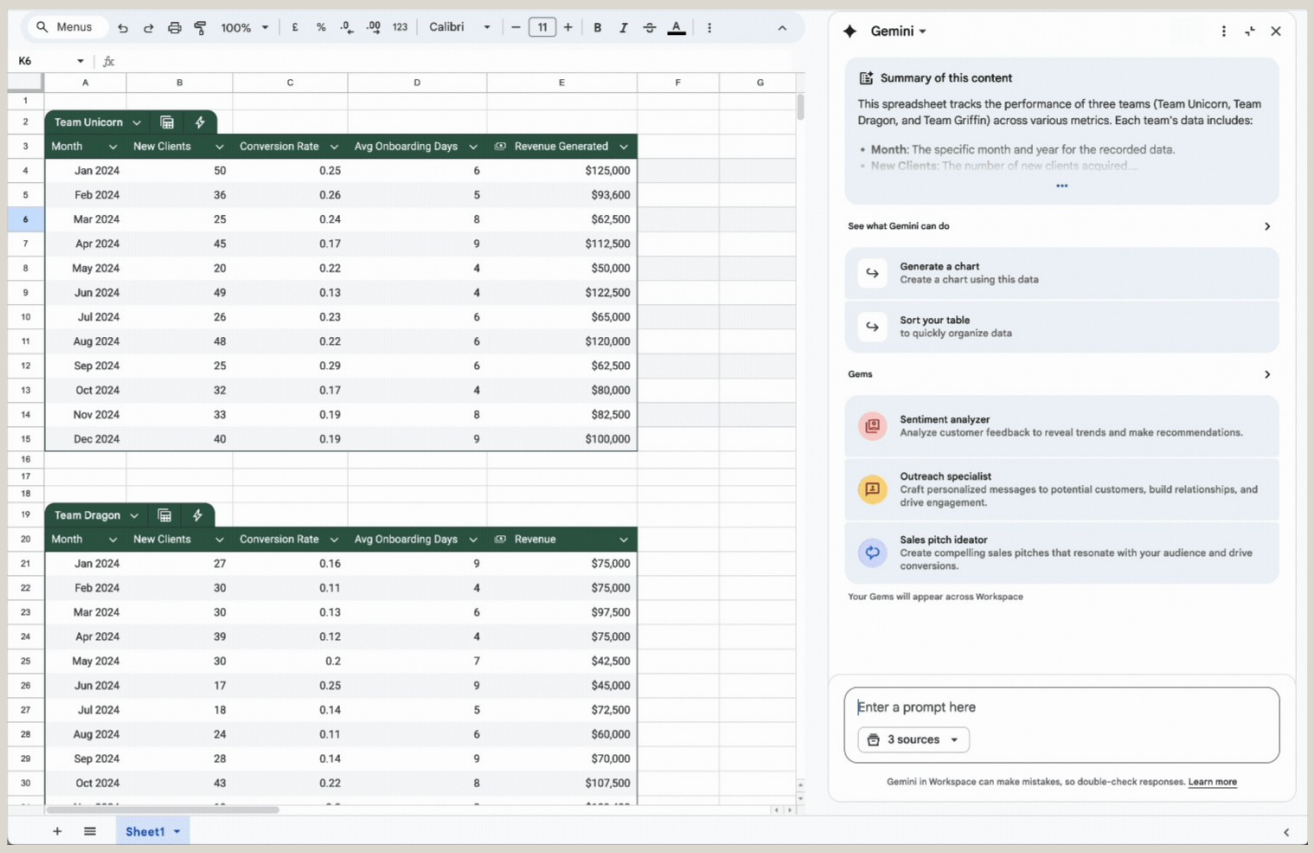
Gemini Panel Controls at a Glance



The controls from Google's Explore Gemini in Sheets table. Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

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The Gemini Side Panel — What Each Part Does



Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

1 — Ask Gemini (spark)
Top right of Sheets. Opens the panel with a summary of the sheet.

2 — Suggestions and Gems
Suggested prompts (More suggestions for others) and premade or custom Gems.

3 — Prompt box and sources
Type a prompt; the sources dropdown picks which tabs Gemini uses.

4 — Response controls
Insert, Copy, Retry, Preview, Analysis steps, Export to Docs, thumbs.

5 — More options, Expand, Close
Clear history; make the panel larger; close it.

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Shortcuts and Key Controls

1

Insert / Copy

Keep a result: insert it into the sheet or copy it.

2

Retry

A different version; Retry with Google Search adds the web.

3

Analysis steps / Show code

See how Gemini calculated an answer.

4

Settings / Undo

Adjust or reverse the last action.

5

Shortcuts

Summarise: Cmd+Ctrl+N / Ctrl+Alt+N. Formula: = then Cmd+Ctrl+G / Ctrl+Alt+G.

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Open Gemini and Explore the Q3 Candidate Export

LAB 1

You are a talent analyst at Orchid Bay Talent Partners, a fictional Singapore recruitment and HR firm. The Q3 2026 hiring drive has just closed its first round: 243 rows exported from the applicant tracking system for eight client roles. You will open the Gemini side panel, read its automatic summary, ask questions in plain English, focus Gemini on the tabs you choose, insert a table into the sheet, and try the panel's controls - Retry, Undo, feedback and Clear history.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Export as a Google Sheets file with an inserted Applications_by_Position table, a check formula that confirms Gemini's stage count, and a filled Prompt_Log

1 Open Gemini	2 Summarise	3 Ask across tabs	4 Insert	5 Spot issues

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini side panel (summary, prompts, sources, Insert) · OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Export.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 1

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Summary:** Give me a five-bullet summary of this candidate data for the Head of Talent.	Gemini condenses the export into five points for a manager - check each number against the sheet.
2	**Question:** Which Source brought in the most applications?	Counts applications per Source. Spelling variants such as 'Linked In' may split a source - you fix that in Lab 3.
3	**Question:** Which recruiter owns the most applications, and for which positions?	Counts applications per Recruiter and links each recruiter to their roles via Position.
4	**Help:** How do I freeze the header row in Google Sheets?	Gemini answers how-to questions about Google Sheets itself, step by step.
5	**Insight:** What's interesting about this data? Give three observations with the numbers behind them.	Gemini looks for patterns and backs each one with a number you can check with COUNTIF.

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Check Your Results — Lab 1

1

Rows and columns

243 rows of data, 16 columns; dates 2026-07-01 to 2026-09-26.

2

Applications_by_Position tab

8 positions; Data Analyst 41 applications for 2 openings; sorted by Applications_per_Opening.

3

Stage check

Rejected = 150 and Hired = 11, matching Gemini's answer.

4

Issues spotted

Gemini lists repeated IDs, Source spelling variants, blank or invalid emails, text salaries and a negative Years_Experience.

5

Prompt_Log

Every prompt you ran has What Gemini did, How I verified and a Decision.

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Why Data Quality Matters

WHAT IT IS

- Complete, consistent, unique, valid data. Typical issues: duplicates, spelling variants, text numbers.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Every count and chart inherits the errors - 'Linked In' and 'LinkedIn' become two sources.

CHECK IT

- Profile before you analyse: rows vs unique IDs, distinct values, data types.

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Try It in Gemini — Why Data Quality Matters

ASK GEMINI

- Check the Applications tab for data-quality problems. Don't change anything.
- Highlight duplicate values in the Candidate_ID column in orange.
- List every distinct Source value exactly as spelt.

THEN CHECK

- 243 rows vs 240 unique IDs.
- =COUNTUNIQUE(...) confirms it.

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Check the Quality of the Candidate Data with Gemini

LAB 2

Before the recruitment manager sees any numbers, you check the raw Q3 export. You will ask Gemini to profile the data, find the repeated Candidate_IDs and the Source spelling variants, and apply conditional formatting actions that highlight duplicates, bad emails, text salaries and impossible values. A Checks tab of formulas confirms every count, and Gemini drafts a short data-quality report. You do not fix anything yet - that is Lab 3.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_QualityCheck with duplicates and problem cells highlighted, a Checks tab of formulas confirming each issue count, an inserted data-quality report and a filled Prompt_Log

1 Profile	2 Find duplicates	3 Highlight issues	4 Count with formulas	5 Report

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini side panel (questions, conditional-formatting actions, formulas) · OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_QualityCheck.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 2

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Profile:** Which columns have blank cells, and how many blanks does each have?	Gemini counts blanks per column - a fast completeness profile.
2	**Validate:** Are there any Applied_Date values outside July to September 2026?	A range check on dates: anything outside the hiring drive is suspicious.
3	**Validate:** Do any rows have a Position that doesn't match the Position for their Job_ID on the Jobs tab?	A cross-tab consistency check between Applications and the Jobs reference table.
4	**Highlight:** Highlight Full_Name cells that are all in capital letters in light purple.	Shows the 4 names typed in capitals, which Lab 3 tidies with PROPER.
5	**Explain:** Why is a salary stored as text a problem when I calculate an average?	Gemini explains the impact of a data-type problem in plain English.

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Check Your Results — Lab 2

1

Duplicates

243 rows, 240 unique IDs; CAN-26531, CAN-26601, CAN-26608 each appear twice; 6 orange cells.

2

Source variants

'Linked In' 3, 'linkedin' 2, 'JobStreet ' (trailing space) 3.

3

Emails

4 blank + 2 without @ (CAN-26697, CAN-26606) = 6 light-red cells.

4

Salaries and experience

5 text salaries in yellow; 1 negative Years_Experience (CAN-26607) in red.

5

Checks tab

Six formulas in column B match the expected values already in column C (243, 240, 4, 2, 5, 1).

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Gemini Actions: Preview, Apply, Undo

WHAT IT IS

- A change Gemini makes from a prompt: shown on an Action preview card, applied when you click Apply.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Menus become sentences - and the preview, Settings and Undo keep you in control.

CHECK IT

- Did you check the result before your next change? Undo only lasts until then.

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Try It with Gemini Actions — Gemini Actions: Preview, Apply, Undo

ASK GEMINI, THEN APPLY

- In the Source column, replace 'Linked In' and 'linkedin' with 'LinkedIn'.
- Delete the Internal_Notes column.
- Freeze the top row and the first column.
- Sort the table by Applied_Date in descending order.

THEN CHECK

- Filter on Source shows 7 values.
- Still 240 rows after each change.

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Data Prep: From Export to Clean Table

WHAT IT IS

- Turn an export into an analysis-ready table: no duplicates, one spelling per category, real numbers.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Clean data is what makes every later formula, chart and AI answer trustworthy.

CHECK IT

- Can you prove the row count before and after each change?

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Try It in Gemini — Data Prep: From Export to Clean Table

ASK GEMINI

- How can I remove duplicate rows on the Applications tab?
- Set Expected_Salary to currency S$ with no decimal places.
- Insert Name_Clean with =PROPER(TRIM(B2)) filled down.
- Apply a table style to the data.

THEN CHECK

- 240 rows, 7 sources.
- =COUNT on salaries = 240.

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Clean and Prepare the Candidate Data with Gemini Actions

LAB 3

You fix everything you found in Lab 2. Gemini explains how to remove duplicates, then performs actions for you: find and replace the Source variants, convert text salaries to numbers with a currency format, add a clean name column, delete the notes column, freeze the headers, apply a table style, and sort and filter the data. A multi-step prompt finishes the clean-up in one go. You check the row count after every change.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Q3_Applications_Prep as a clean table: 240 rows, seven Source values, numeric S$ salaries, a Name_Clean column, frozen headers, a Stage dropdown and Hired rows highlighted

1 Remove duplicates	2 Fix categories	3 Fix types	4 Restructure	5 Sort & filter

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini actions (find and replace, number format, insert/delete column, freeze, sort, filter, table style) · Data cleanup

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Sample Prompts — Lab 3

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Fill:** Fill the empty Email cells with the text 'missing - ask candidate'.	Fill range: writes one value into every selected empty cell - flagging the gaps instead of hiding them.
2	**Insert:** Insert a new column called Source_Group after Source and leave it empty.	Insert dimension: adds an empty column exactly where you name it.
3	**Number format:** Format Screening_Score as a whole number and Interview_Score with one decimal place.	Set number format: controls how numbers display without changing their values.
4	**Delete rows:** Delete the rows where Stage is Withdrawn.	Delete dimension: removes rows that match a condition. Try it on a copy - then Undo.
5	**Help:** How do I split the Key_Skills column into separate columns?	Gemini explains Data > Split text to columns with ; as the separator.

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Check Your Results — Lab 3

1

Rows

240 rows after removing 3 duplicates.

2

Source

Exactly 7 values in the filter; LinkedIn 49, JobStreet 50.

3

Salaries

=COUNT over the Expected_Salary column returns 240; values show as S$ with no decimals.

4

Structure

Name_Clean filled to the last row; Internal_Notes gone; headers frozen; CAN-26607 shows 3 years.

5

Sort, filter, dropdown

Newest date (2026-09-26) at the top; the filter showed 2 rows; Stage dropdown added; 11 Hired rows light green.

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Formulas: VLOOKUP, COUNTIF and Nested IF

WHAT IT IS

- VLOOKUP fetches from a table, IF decides, nested IF/AND handles several outcomes, COUNTIF(S) counts.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Rules become repeatable and auditable - change a threshold once and everyone is re-screened.

CHECK IT

- Can you work row 2 out by hand and get the same answer?

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Try It in Gemini — Formulas: VLOOKUP, COUNTIF and Nested IF

DESCRIBE THE RULE

- Look up the Job_ID in E2 on Jobs and return Min_Years.
- Return Within budget if K2 <= Q2, otherwise Above budget.
- Strong if M2 >= pass mark AND H2 >= R2; Possible if M2 >= 60; else Not suitable.

THEN CHECK

- Row 2 checked by hand.
- Totals add up to 240.

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Generate, Explain and Fix Formulas with Gemini

WHAT IT IS

- Describe it and Gemini writes it; ask and Gemini explains it; hover an error and Fix repairs it.

WHY IT MATTERS

- No syntax to memorise - but you still read, explain and check every formula.

CHECK IT

- Could you explain this formula to a colleague in one sentence?

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Try It in Gemini — Generate, Explain and Fix Formulas with Gemini

ASK GEMINI FOR THE FORMULA

- Type = in a cell, then Cmd + Ctrl + G (Mac) / Ctrl + Alt + G.
- Explain the formula in T2 step by step.
- Hover over #REF! > Fix.

THEN CHECK

- Q2 shows S$6,500 after Fix.
- Explanation matches row 2.

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Generate, Explain and Fix Screening Formulas

LAB 4

The hiring managers want a first screen of all 240 applications. You will fix a broken lookup with Gemini's Fix button, then describe each rule in plain English and let Gemini write the formula: a VLOOKUP for the role's minimum experience, an IF for salary fit, and a nested IF with AND that labels each candidate Strong, Possible or Not suitable. Gemini explains the formula, COUNTIF and COUNTIFS summarise the results, and independent check formulas prove them.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Screening_Formulas with working Budget_Max, Min_Years, Salary_Fit and Screen_Result columns, a Checks tab of COUNTIF/COUNTIFS results that reconcile to 240, and a filled Prompt_Log

1 Fix an error	2 VLOOKUP	3 IF	4 Nested IF	5 COUNTIF & check

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini formula help (side panel, = then Cmd/Ctrl + Ctrl/Alt + G, Fix) · OrchidBay_Screening_Formulas.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 4

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Lookup:** Create a formula that returns the Hiring_Manager for the Job_ID in E2 from the Jobs tab (A2:J9).	VLOOKUP again, returning a different column (10, Hiring_Manager).
2	**Date:** Create a formula for the number of days between Applied_Date in D2 and the report date in Settings!B1.	Writes =Settings!B1-D2: subtracting dates gives the number of days.
3	**Text:** Create a formula that returns TRUE if Key_Skills in J2 contains "SQL".	Writes =REGEXMATCH(J2,"SQL") or =ISNUMBER(SEARCH("SQL",J2)) - a keyword screen.
4	**Count:** Create a formula that counts Above budget candidates for each Position.	Gemini may build a small table of COUNTIFS - check one row by hand.
5	**Explain:** Explain the difference between VLOOKUP and XLOOKUP, and when to use each.	Gemini explains both lookups; XLOOKUP needs no column number and can look left.

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Check Your Results — Lab 4

1

Fix

Q2 = S$6,500; no #REF! left in column Q.

2

Row 2

CAN-26481: Min_Years 2, Salary_Fit Within budget, Screen_Result Possible.

3

Screen_Result totals

Strong 88 + Possible 73 + Not suitable 79 = 240.

4

COUNTIFS

Strong Data Analysts = 14; Above budget = 62 (Within budget 178).

5

What-if

Pass mark 75 gives 60 Strong; set back to 70 gives 88.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Fundamentals of Google Sheet

1. LO1 · Side panel: Summaries, questions across chosen tabs, Insert, Retry, Undo and Clear history.
2. LO1 · Data quality: Duplicates, spelling variants, bad emails, text numbers and impossible values found and counted.
3. LO1 · Data prep: Gemini actions - find and replace, number format, insert/delete, freeze, sort, filter - with counts before and after.
4. LO1 · Formulas: VLOOKUP, IF, nested IF and COUNTIFS from plain English; explained, fixed and reconciled.

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TOPIC 02

Data Analytics and Visualization

tables, trackers and dropdowns · conditional formatting · the AI function and Fill with Gemini · data analysis, insights and pivot tables · charts and graphs

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Key Concepts — Data Analytics and Visualization

1

Structure from text

Gemini turns notes into a table you refine before you insert it.

2

Rules that colour

Conditional formatting flags what matters; Settings lets you edit the rule.

3

AI in a cell

=AI(prompt, range) extracts, categorises and summarises text row by row.

4

Insights with evidence

Analysis steps show how Gemini calculated; you confirm with a formula.

5

Pivot tables on request

Gemini builds a pivot table; you adjust it and check its totals.

6

Inserted charts are copies

A chart Gemini inserts doesn't follow later changes - build linked ones too.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Data Analytics and Visualization

Labs 5–6

- **Tables, Trackers & Conditional Formatting**
  - Build a Colour-Coded Interview Tracker from Unstructured Notes
- **AI Function & Fill with Gemini**
  - Extract and Categorise Candidate Text with the AI Function

Labs 7–8

- **Data Analysis & Insights**
  - Generate Hiring Insights and Pivot Tables with Gemini
- **Charts & Visualisation**
  - Build Charts That Tell the Hiring Story

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Tables, Trackers and Dropdowns

WHAT IT IS

- Gemini builds tables from scratch or from notes; dropdowns and checkboxes keep trackers consistent.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Consistent input today means reliable analysis tomorrow.

CHECK IT

- Does every note appear once, with a valid Status?

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Try It in Gemini — Tables, Trackers and Dropdowns

ASK GEMINI, THEN INSERT

- Using the notes on Interview_Notes, create a table with Date, Time, Candidate … and Status.
- Follow-up: add Outcome and Reference_Checked columns.
- Make Status a dropdown with Scheduled, Completed, No-show and Rescheduled.

THEN CHECK

- 12 rows; statuses 5/3/2/2.
- Dropdowns and checkboxes work.

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Conditional Formatting with Gemini

WHAT IT IS

- Formatting that follows a rule: highlight rows, compare columns, colour scales, duplicates.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Exceptions jump out without changing the data - and update as the data changes.

CHECK IT

- Does a COUNTIF give the same number as the coloured rows?

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Try It in Gemini — Conditional Formatting with Gemini

ASK GEMINI, THEN APPLY

- Highlight rows where Screening_Score is 85 or more in light green.
- Make Expected_Salary bold red when it is greater than Budget_Max.
- Add a colour scale to Interview_Score from red to green.

THEN CHECK

- 11 green rows (21 at 80).
- 12 red salaries.

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Build a Colour-Coded Interview Tracker from Unstructured Notes

LAB 5

The recruiters typed this week's interview notes as free text. You will ask Gemini to turn them into a structured table, refine it before inserting, and make it a working tracker with Status and Outcome dropdowns and a Reference_Checked checkbox. Conditional-formatting actions colour-code the tracker and flag the shortlist: top screening scores, salaries above budget and long notice periods. You will edit a rule with Settings, run a multi-step clean-up prompt, and create an onboarding checklist from scratch.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker with an Interview_Tracker tab (12 interviews, dropdowns, checkboxes, colour-coded Status), a flagged Shortlist tab and a new Onboarding_Checklist tab

1 Notes to table	2 Dropdowns & checkboxes	3 Colour-code	4 Flag the shortlist	5 Multi-step clean-up

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini (create tables, Insert, dropdown, checkbox and conditional-formatting actions, Settings) · OrchidBay_Interview_Tracker.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 5

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Table:** Create a table of interview questions for a Data Analyst, with columns Question, Skill tested and What a good answer includes.	Gemini drafts a structured interview guide you can insert and reuse.
2	**Dropdown:** Convert the Recruiter column on the Shortlist tab to a dropdown with values from the same column.	Turns an existing column into a dropdown of its own values.
3	**Highlight:** Highlight the Shortlist rows where Stage is Offered in light purple.	Another row-highlight rule - check the count with COUNTIF.
4	**Freeze:** Freeze the top row and the first two columns of the Shortlist tab.	A freeze action keeps IDs and names visible as you scroll right.
5	**Help:** Teach me how to use conditional formatting with a custom formula.	Gemini explains custom-formula rules in Format > Conditional formatting, step by step.

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Check Your Results — Lab 5

1

Interview_Tracker

12 rows; Completed 5, Scheduled 3, Rescheduled 2, No-show 2.

2

Tracker controls

Status and Outcome dropdowns work; Reference_Checked has checkboxes; Status is colour-coded.

3

Shortlist flags

11 green rows at 85, then 21 after editing the rule to 80; 12 salaries in bold red; Interview_Score has a colour scale.

4

Multi-step

Stage dropdown, Notice_End dates, Contacted checkboxes; 5 light-orange rows.

5

Onboarding_Checklist

13 tasks (10 + 3 IT tasks) with a Done checkbox column.

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The AI Function (=AI)

WHAT IT IS

- =AI("prompt", range) in a cell: generate, summarise, categorise, or search - row by row.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Free text becomes columns you can filter and count - once you have measured the accuracy.

CHECK IT

- How many AI answers match the recorded values?

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Try It in Gemini — The AI Function (=AI)

TYPE IN A CELL

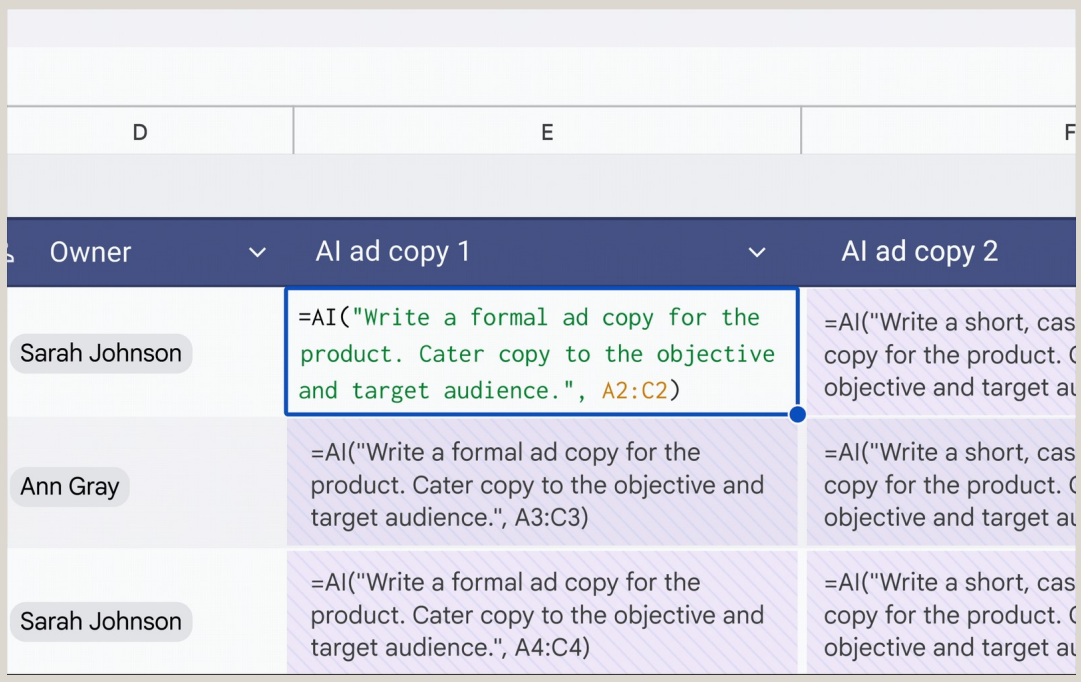
- =AI("Extract the notice period in weeks. Output only the number.", D2)
- =AI("Classify this feedback as Positive, Mixed or Negative.", E2)
- Select the cells > Generate and insert.

THEN CHECK

- Notice matches near 30/30.
- Sentiment split vs Answer_Key.

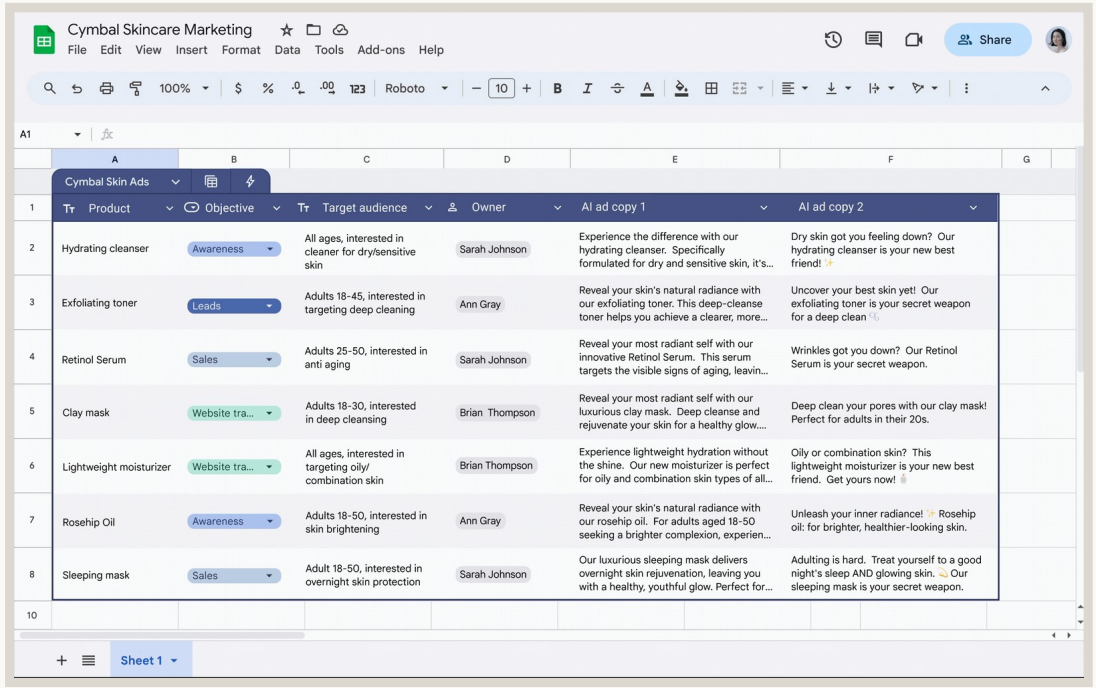
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The AI Function in Google Sheets



Type the =AI formula

A prompt plus the cells it should use.



Generate and insert

Gemini fills every selected AI cell.

Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

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Fill with Gemini and AI Columns

ASK GEMINI

- Type an example in I2, select I2:I31 > Fill.
- Group the Interview_Feedback into themes and count each.
- Do any summaries mention personal characteristics?

THEN CHECK

- I2:I31 filled.
- Theme counts add up to 30.

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Extract and Categorise Candidate Text with the AI Function

LAB 6

Hiring managers want a quick read of 30 shortlisted candidates, but the details are buried in free text. You will type =AI formulas that extract the notice period in weeks, classify each interview feedback as Positive, Mixed or Negative, and write a one-line summary that leaves out personal characteristics. You will generate the outputs, compare them with an answer key using formulas, use Fill with Gemini for a skills column, and ask the side panel to group the feedback into themes.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles with AI-filled Notice_Weeks_AI, Feedback_Sentiment_AI, Manager_Summary_AI and Top_Skills columns, a Checks tab measuring accuracy, and an inserted feedback-themes table

1 Extract	2 Categorise	3 Summarise	4 Measure accuracy	5 Fill & group

Tools: Google Sheets · AI function (=AI, Generate and insert) · Fill with Gemini · Gemini side panel · OrchidBay_Candidate_Profiles.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 6

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**AI function:** =AI("Does this candidate mention SQL? Answer Yes or No.", D2)	A yes/no extraction - easy to check with SEARCH or REGEXMATCH.
2	**AI function:** =AI("Write a polite two-sentence email inviting this candidate to a second interview.", B2:C2)	Generates text from two cells - always read it before sending anything.
3	**Categorise:** =AI("Classify the seniority of this candidate as Junior, Mid or Senior based on years of experience.", D2)	Categorises into your own definitions; give the definitions in the prompt for consistent results.
4	**Side panel:** Which five candidates have the most positive feedback? Show their names and positions.	The side panel answers across all 30 rows at once.
5	**Side panel:** Summarise the main concerns interviewers raised, with the number of candidates for each.	Turns free text into counted themes you can act on.

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Check Your Results — Lab 6

1

Notice_Weeks_AI

30 numbers; row 2 = 0; Notice matches close to 30 (recorded: 8 candidates with 8+ weeks).

2

Feedback_Sentiment_AI

Recorded split Positive 9, Mixed 16, Negative 5; your Sentiment matches count shows how many agree.

3

Manager_Summary_AI

H2:H6 filled with one sentence each and no personal characteristics.

4

Top_Skills

I2:I31 filled by Fill with Gemini (or =AI), following your example in I2.

5

Feedback_Themes

An inserted themes table whose counts add up to 30.

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Data Analysis and Insights with Gemini

WHAT IT IS

- Ask questions of the data: trends, comparisons, rates. Analysis steps shows the working.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A first answer in seconds - made defensible with a formula check.

CHECK IT

- Which number in Gemini's insight did you confirm with COUNTIFS?

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Try It in Gemini — Data Analysis and Insights with Gemini

ASK GEMINI

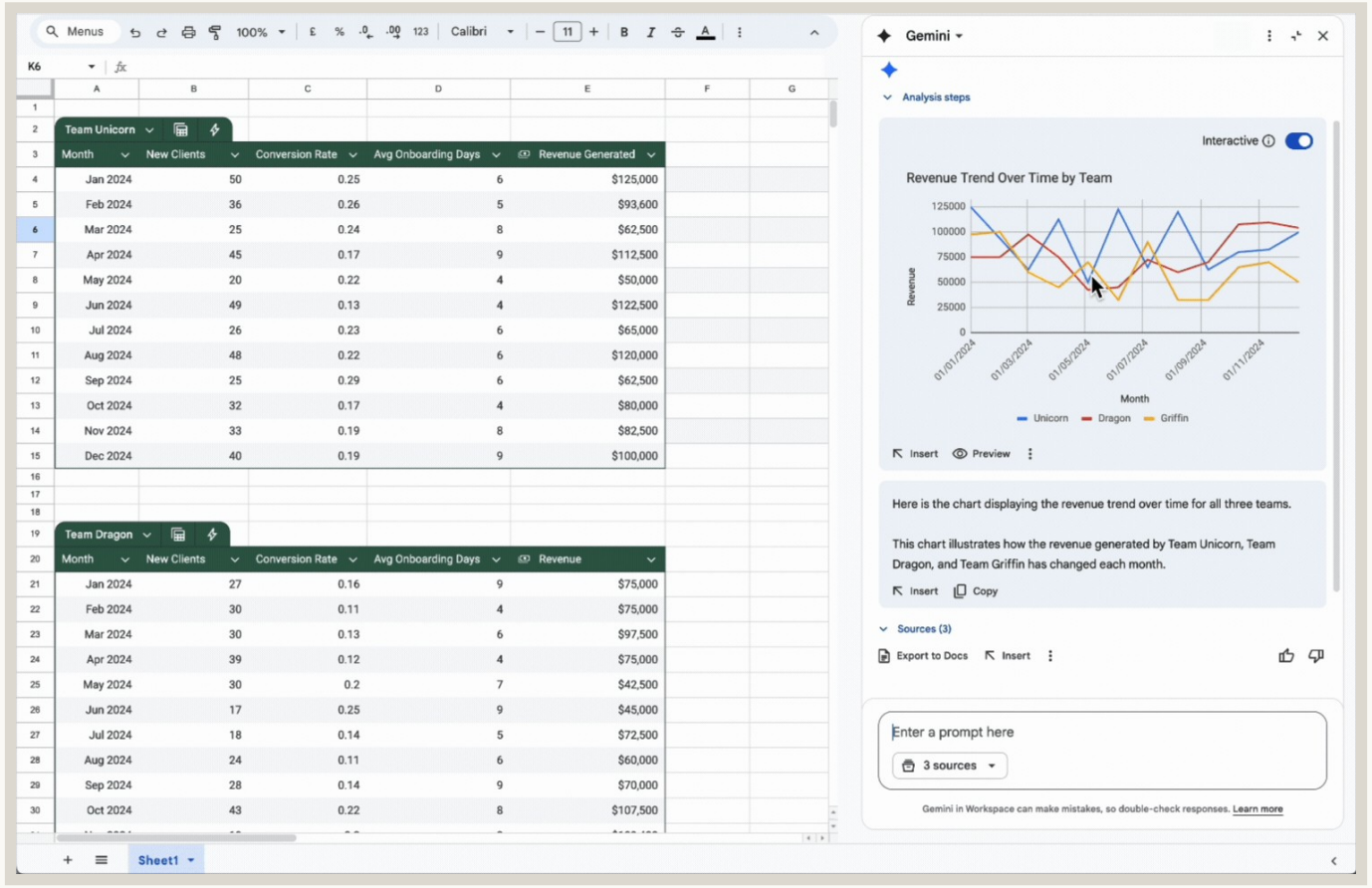
- What analysis can you help me perform with this sheet?
- Identify trends in applications by Month.
- Which Source has the best hire rate?
- Export to Docs.

THEN CHECK

- Peak June 98.
- Referral 12.8%.

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A Gemini Analysis Response



Analysis steps, Insert, Preview, Copy, Sources, Export to Docs and feedback. Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

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Pivot Tables with Gemini

ASK GEMINI, THEN APPLY

- Create a pivot table: count of Candidate_ID, Source in rows, Stage in columns.
- Click Settings to add a filter.
- =COUNTIFS(… "LinkedIn" … "Hired")

THEN CHECK

- Grand total 720.
- LinkedIn Hired 11.

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Generate Hiring Insights and Pivot Tables with Gemini

LAB 7

Orchid Bay's Head of Talent wants to know how 2026 hiring is going. Using all 720 applications from January to September, you will ask Gemini what analysis is possible, find the monthly trend, compare sources by hire rate and cost per hire, and find which role takes longest to fill. You will open Analysis steps to see how Gemini calculated, create pivot tables with Gemini actions and adjust them with Settings, check every figure with COUNTIFS or AVERAGEIFS, and export five insights to a Google Doc.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Hiring_2026_YTD with two pivot tables (source by stage, days to hire by position), a Checks area of formulas, and a Google Doc of insights exported from Gemini

1 Explore	2 Trends	3 Compare sources	4 Pivot tables	5 Export insights

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini data analysis (Analysis steps, Export to Docs) · pivot-table actions · OrchidBay_Hiring_2026_YTD.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 7

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Trend:** How did the number of hires change from Q1 to Q2 to Q3 2026?	Groups months into quarters - check it with COUNTIFS on Month.
2	**Compare:** Compare the average Screening_Score of hired and rejected candidates.	Compares two groups on one measure - is screening predicting who gets hired?
3	**Pivot:** Create a pivot table that shows the number of hires by Recruiter and Month.	A two-dimensional pivot table, created and adjustable with Settings.
4	**Regression:** How can I show regression and prediction of monthly applications?	Gemini explains trend lines and forecasting - treat any prediction as an estimate.
5	**Explain:** Explain this analysis like I'm a hiring manager with no data background.	Asks Gemini to rewrite the same findings for a different audience.

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Check Your Results — Lab 7

1

Trend

Peak June 2026 (98 applications); lowest February (62).

2

Sources

Best hire rate Referral 12.8%; most hires LinkedIn (11); 41 hires in total.

3

Pivot 1

Source x Stage; LinkedIn Hired 11, Rejected 147; grand total 720.

4

Pivot 2

HR Executive slowest at 39.3 days; AVERAGEIFS matches.

5

Cost per hire

Cheapest Company Website S$125; dearest Career Fair S$1,540; insights exported to a Google Doc.

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Charts and Graphs with Gemini

WHAT IT IS

- Describe the chart; Preview, then Insert. Gemini adds a new tab with the chart and its data.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A good chart makes the finding obvious - and its title should say it.

CHECK IT

- Does the title state the finding, not just the measure?

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Try It in Gemini — Charts and Graphs with Gemini

ASK GEMINI, THEN INSERT

- Create a line chart with Month on the x-axis and applications on the y-axis.
- Make a bar chart of hires by Source, sorted from most to fewest.
- Suggest a title for each chart that states the main finding.

THEN CHECK

- Peak June 98.
- Funnel 720/61/47/41.

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Inserted vs Linked Charts

ASK GEMINI

- Will the chart you inserted update if I change the Applications tab?
- Create a pivot table that counts Candidate_ID by Month.
- Then Insert > Chart on the pivot table.

THEN CHECK

- Inserted chart unchanged.
- Pivot chart updated.

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Build Charts That Tell the Hiring Story

LAB 8

Now you show the findings from Lab 7. You will ask Gemini to create charts - a monthly trend line, hires by source and the hiring funnel - preview them and insert them. Each inserted chart lands on a new tab with its own copy of the data, so it does not update when Applications changes. You will prove that, then build a linked chart from a pivot table that does update. A cost-per-hire chart combines two tabs, and you will rewrite every title to state its finding and add alt text.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Hiring_Charts with four inserted Gemini charts, one linked chart built from a pivot table, finding-based titles and alt text

1 Trend chart	2 Source & funnel	3 Static vs linked	4 Cost chart	5 Titles & alt text

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini charts (Preview, Insert, Copy chart) · pivot table · Chart editor · OrchidBay_Hiring_Charts.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 8

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Pie:** Create a pie chart of applications by Source.	Shows each source's share - LinkedIn is 25.6% of applications. Pies suit a few categories only.
2	**Stacked:** Create a stacked column chart of applications by Month, split by Stage.	Shows totals and the stage mix together.
3	**Combo:** Create a chart with applications as columns and hires as a line, by Month.	Two measures on one chart - check that the two axes are labelled.
4	**Help:** What chart type is best to show the share of each source over time?	Gemini as a chart adviser - it explains the trade-offs.
5	**Graph:** Create a graph that shows the percentage of applications that came from each Position.	A percentage chart - check the slices add up to 100%.

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Check Your Results — Lab 8

1

Trend chart

Line chart on its own tab; peak June 98.

2

Source and funnel

Bars sorted; LinkedIn 11 first. Funnel 720 / 61 / 47 / 41.

3

Static vs linked

Inserted chart did not change after the Stage edit; the Month x Stage pivot chart did.

4

Cost per hire

Company Website S$125 lowest; Career Fair S$1,540 highest.

5

Titles and alt text

Every chart title states a finding; every chart has alt text.

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Recap - Data Analytics and Visualization

1. LO2 · Tables and trackers: Notes turned into a colour-coded tracker with dropdowns, checkboxes and editable rules.
2. LO2 · AI function: =AI extracts, categorises and summarises text; accuracy measured against an answer key.
3. LO2 · Analysis: Trends, rates and cost per hire with Analysis steps; pivot tables checked with COUNTIFS.
4. LO2 · Charts: Inserted (static) and linked charts; titles that state the finding; alt text.

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TOPIC 03

Interactive Dashboard

dropdown selectors and KPI formulas · linked charts, alerts and protection · Gems for repeatable screening · optimisation, reporting and responsible sharing

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Key Concepts — Interactive Dashboard

1

Selectors drive everything

Dropdowns feed COUNTIFS; 'All' becomes the wildcard *.

2

KPIs are formulas

Never type a number Gemini told you - the dashboard must recalculate.

3

Charts on live ranges

Insert > Chart on the dashboard tables, so charts follow the dropdowns.

4

Gems for repeat work

Saved instructions + knowledge files = the same screening every time.

5

Optimise, then decide

Gemini's solver finds the best combination; a person makes the call.

6

Share the minimum

Only the fields a viewer needs, view-only, after the external-sharing warning.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Interactive Dashboard

Labs 9–10

- **Dashboard KPIs & Selectors**
  - Build the Dashboard's Selectors and KPI Formulas
- **Interactive Dashboard**
  - Make the Hiring Dashboard Interactive and Visual

Labs 11–12

- **Gems**
  - Create a Candidate Screener Gem and Use It in Sheets
- **Optimisation, Reporting & Safe Sharing**
  - Optimise the Hiring Decision and Share Results Safely

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What Makes a Dashboard Interactive

ASK GEMINI, THEN APPLY

- Create a dropdown in C3 with the values from Lists! A2:A10.
- Create a dropdown in C4 with the values from Lists! B2:B9.
- Set both to All.

THEN CHECK

- C3 lists All + 8 positions.
- C4 lists All + 7 sources.

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KPI Formulas Driven by Dropdowns

WHAT IT IS

- COUNTIFS/AVERAGEIFS with IF(C3="All","*", C3): every KPI follows the dropdowns.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Formula KPIs recalculate instantly - test 'All', one group and an empty mix.

CHECK IT

- What does your formula return when a combination has no rows?

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Try It in Gemini — KPI Formulas Driven by Dropdowns

DESCRIBE THE KPI

- Count rows where Position = C3 and Source = C4; All means any value.
- Hires: the same count where Stage is Hired.
- Hire rate: E7/B7, 0 if B7 is 0.

THEN CHECK

- All/All: 720 and 41.
- No #DIV/0! anywhere.

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Build the Dashboard's Selectors and KPI Formulas

LAB 9

The Head of Talent wants one page that answers 'how is hiring going?' for any role and any source. You will turn two cells into dropdown selectors, then ask Gemini for the formulas: COUNTIFS that treat 'All' as 'every value', a hire rate, AVERAGEIFS for screening score and days to hire, and the funnel, monthly and source tables that the charts in Lab 10 will use. Every KPI is a formula, never a typed number, so it changes when the selectors change - and you test that it does.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build with Position and Source dropdowns in C3:C4, a KPI row (B7:H7) and funnel, monthly and source tables that all respond to the dropdowns

1 Selectors	2 Count KPIs	3 Rate & average KPIs	4 Summary tables	5 Test the filters

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini dropdown actions and formula generation (COUNTIFS, AVERAGEIFS, IFERROR) · OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 9

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**KPI:** Create a formula for the offer acceptance rate: Hired divided by Offered plus Hired, for the selected Position and Source.	A ratio KPI built from two COUNTIFS - check it on one position by hand.
2	**KPI:** Create a formula that returns the most common Source for the selected Position.	Gemini may use INDEX/MATCH or QUERY; verify with the Lab 7 source table.
3	**Selector:** Create a dropdown in C5 with the values 2026-01 to 2026-09.	A third selector you could add to the COUNTIFS criteria.
4	**Explain:** Explain the formula in B7 to someone who has never used COUNTIFS.	A plain-language explanation for a colleague who will maintain the dashboard.
5	**Check:** Which formulas on the Dashboard tab would break if a new Position were added?	Gemini reviews the dashboard's robustness - the Lists ranges are fixed-size.

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Check Your Results — Lab 9

1

Selectors

C3 lists All + 8 positions; C4 lists All + 7 sources.

2

All / All

B7:H7 = 720, 61, 47, 41, 5.7%, 65.5, 31.1.

3

Tables

Funnel 720/61/47/41; June applications 98; LinkedIn hires 11.

4

Software Engineer

104 applications, 6 hires, 5.8%; the COUNTIFS check shows 6.

5

Data Analyst + LinkedIn

30 applications, 0 hires; H7 shows '-' (no error).

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Dashboard Design: Charts, Alerts and Protection

WHAT IT IS

- Selectors on top, KPIs in a row, linked charts below, alerts on the KPIs, everything else protected.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Other people will use it - clarity, alerts and protection make it trustworthy.

CHECK IT

- Change a dropdown: does every chart redraw?

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From KPI Formulas to Dashboard

1. Selectors and KPI formulas (Lab 9)
2. Linked charts on dashboard tables
3. Metric switch
4. KPI alerts
5. Protect, summarise, share

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Build It with Gemini — Dashboard Design: Charts, Alerts and Protection

ASK GEMINI

- How do I insert a chart from a range so that it updates?
- Create a dropdown in C5 with Applications and Hires.
- Highlight F7 in light red when it is below 5%.

THEN CHECK

- Charts redraw for each Position.
- Alerts fire for HR Executive.

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Make the Hiring Dashboard Interactive and Visual

LAB 10

The KPI formulas from Lab 9 are ready: dropdowns in C3:C4 drive the KPIs and three tables. You will add charts that are linked to those tables (unlike Gemini-inserted charts, which are static copies), so they redraw when a dropdown changes. A third dropdown switches the monthly chart between Applications and Hires, and conditional-formatting alerts flag a low hire rate and a slow time to hire. You will hide the gridlines, protect the formulas, and ask Gemini to summarise the dashboard for the Head of Talent.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive: a protected Dashboard tab with three linked charts, a metric switch, KPI alerts and a Gemini summary exported to Google Docs

1 Linked charts	2 Test views	3 Metric switch	4 KPI alerts	5 Polish & summarise

Tools: Google Sheets · Insert > Chart (linked) · Gemini actions (dropdown, conditional formatting) and formulas · Export to Docs · OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 10

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Image:** Create an image of a simple header banner with an orchid and the words Hiring Dashboard.	Gemini generates an image; Insert image places it on the sheet. Keep branding simple and fictional.
2	**Layout:** Suggest a clean layout for this dashboard: where should the KPIs, charts and selectors go?	Gemini as a design adviser - you decide what to apply.
3	**Alert:** Highlight the Hires cells in the monthly table that are 0 in light grey.	Another conditional-formatting rule for empty months.
4	**Number format:** Format F7 as a percentage with one decimal place and G7:H7 with one decimal place.	A set-number-format action for the KPI row.
5	**Review:** Review this dashboard for a colleague: what is unclear, and what would you add?	A critique from Gemini - a quick usability check before you share.

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Check Your Results — Lab 10

1

Linked charts

Three charts built with Insert > Chart from E10:G19 (or E10:E19 + H10:H19), B10:C14 and I10:J17.

2

Customer Success Executive

103 applications, 7 hires, 6.8%; all charts redraw.

3

Metric switch

C5 = Hires changes the line chart and the H10 header to 'Monthly Hires'.

4

Alerts

Operations Supervisor: F7 red (4.3%). HR Executive: F7 red (3.5%), H7 amber (39.3).

5

Polish

No gridlines, Lists hidden, Dashboard protected except C3:C5; summary exported to Docs.

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Gems: Reusable Expert Assistants

WHAT IT IS

- A custom Gemini with saved instructions and knowledge files - reused from the Sheets side panel.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The same rubric and format every time: faster, more consistent screening.

CHECK IT

- Did you test the Gem on a candidate whose answer you already know?

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Build Your Gem — Gems: Reusable Expert Assistants

IN THE GEMINI APP

- gemini.google.com > Gems > New Gem.
- Paste Persona / Task / Context / Format instructions.
- Add the job descriptions and rubric from Drive.
- In Sheets: Ask Gemini > Gems > your Gem.

THEN CHECK

- Test candidate scores 12/20, Hold.
- Gaps match the data.

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Writing Gem Instructions That Are Fair

GEM INSTRUCTIONS

- PERSONA: careful, fair recruitment analyst.
- CONTEXT: use only the row and the job description.
- Never use age, gender, race, religion, nationality …
- FORMAT: one table, with a one-line reason.

THEN CHECK

- Reasons cite evidence only.
- Unsure cases listed.

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Create a Candidate Screener Gem and Use It in Sheets

LAB 11

Screening 16 finalists by hand takes the recruiters a day, and every recruiter scores a little differently. You will create a Gem - a custom Gemini with saved instructions - in the Gemini app. Its instructions follow the Persona, Task, Context and Format pattern; its knowledge is the job descriptions and the screening rubric from Google Drive. You will test it on one candidate, open it from the Gems list in the Sheets side panel, screen all four roles, insert the results, check them against the data and record the human decision.

You'll build

An 'Orchid Bay Candidate Screener' Gem with instructions and two knowledge files, and OrchidBay_Finalists with a Gem_Screening tab, checks and a Hiring_Manager_Decision dropdown

1 Write instructions	2 Add knowledge	3 Test the Gem	4 Screen in Sheets	5 Check & decide

Tools: Gemini app (gemini.google.com) · Gems · Google Drive · Google Sheets Gemini side panel (Gems) · OrchidBay_Finalists.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 11

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Gem:** Write three interview questions for the weakest rubric area of each Advance candidate.	The Gem builds on its own screening to prepare the next interview.
2	**Gem:** Rank the Software Engineer finalists by Total and explain the ranking in one sentence each.	A ranked shortlist with reasons - check that the ranks follow the totals.
3	**Gem:** Draft a polite email to a candidate you recommend we Decline, without giving scores.	The Gem drafts candidate communication; a person reviews it before sending.
4	**Gemini app:** Improve my Gem instructions so the Reason column always quotes the evidence.	Gemini helps you improve the Gem itself.
5	**Side panel:** What are the main points of OrchidBay_Screening_Rubric?	Gemini summarises a Drive file by name; expand Sources to see which file it used.

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Check Your Results — Lab 11

1

Gem

Saved as 'Orchid Bay Candidate Screener' with instructions and both knowledge files.

2

Test candidate

CAN-26693: gap Tableau; 12/20; Hold.

3

Must-have gaps

CAN-26693 (Tableau); CAN-26699 (JavaScript); CAN-26622 (JavaScript); CAN-26621 (Reconciliation); CAN-26579 (Accounting).

4

Salary check

Above-budget formula = 4 (CAN-26567, CAN-26577, CAN-26579, CAN-26662).

5

Decisions

Rubric applied exactly: 7 Advance / 8 Hold / 1 Decline; Hiring_Manager_Decision dropdown added and filled by you.

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The Optimization Problem Solver

ASK GEMINI

- Maximise the total Weighted_Score.
- Hire exactly the Openings per Position.
- Keep total Expected_Salary within Constraints!B8.

THEN CHECK

- Within budget = TRUE.
- Two per role, 8 in total.

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Sharing and Responsible Use

WHAT IT IS

- Use Drive and Gmail as context, check Sources, share minimal views, and keep a human decision.

WHY IT MATTERS

- HR data is personal: minimise it, check it, and stay accountable.

CHECK IT

- What is the least data this viewer needs to see?

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Try It in Gemini — Sharing and Responsible Use

ASK GEMINI

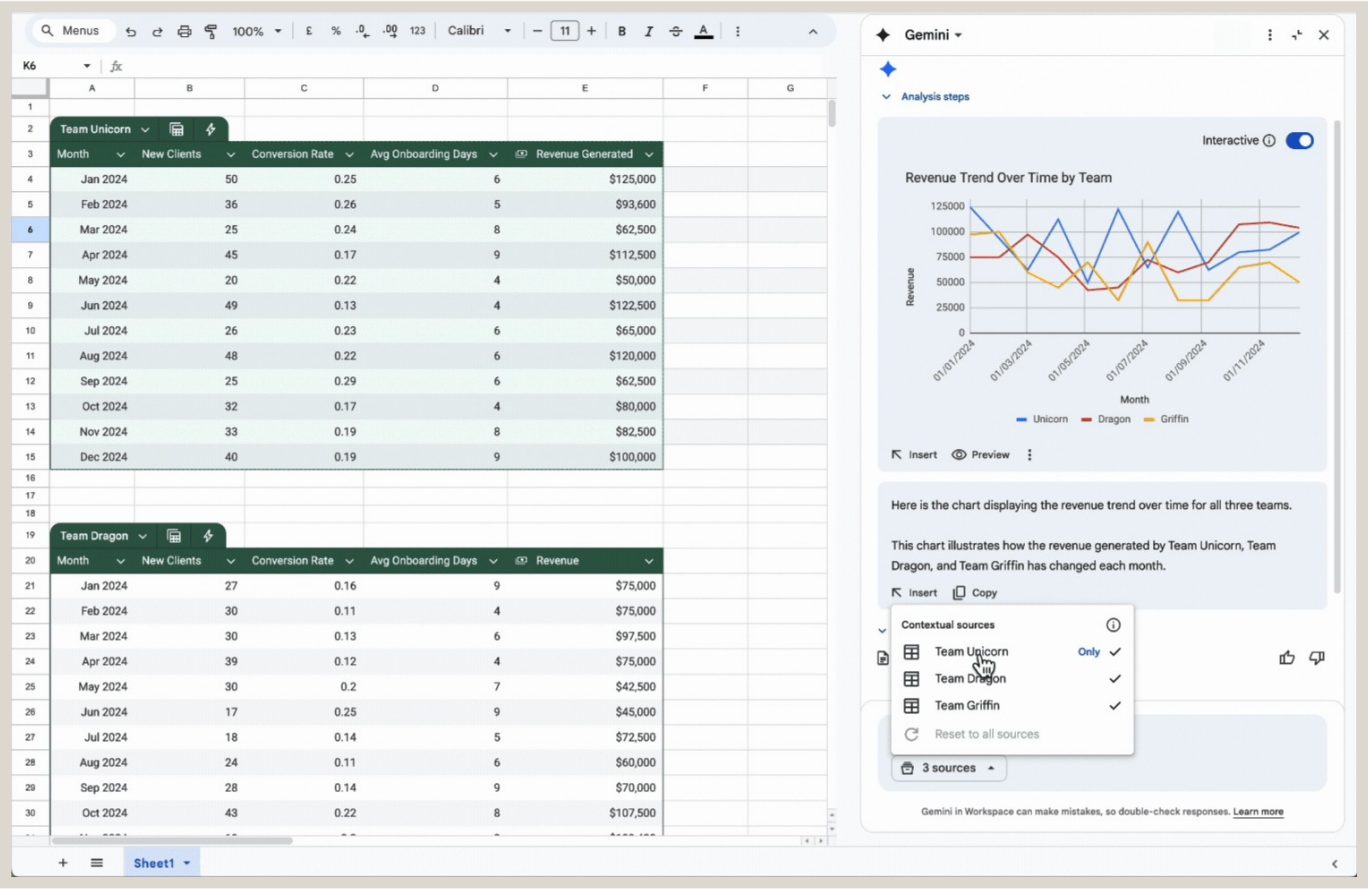
- What are the main points of OrchidBay_Screening_Rubric?
- Which columns contain personal data the client doesn't need?
- Create a Share_View tab with only four columns.

THEN CHECK

- Sources expanded and checked.
- Shared as Viewer only.

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Choosing Gemini's Sources



Gemini lists the sources it used - and you can limit it to the tabs you choose. Screenshot: Google Docs Editors Help - Collaborate with Gemini in Google Sheets

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Optimise the Hiring Decision and Share Results Safely

LAB 12

The client wants eight hires - two for each of four roles - and one total monthly salary budget of S$41,900. Picking the top two in each role costs S$43,100, which is over budget. You will describe the problem to Gemini's optimisation solver, compare its answer with the no-budget choice, tick the selected candidates and prove the totals with formulas. Then you will export a recommendation to Google Docs, use a Drive file as context, build a minimal Share_View tab and share it safely.

You'll build

OrchidBay_Hiring_Decision with a Selected checkbox column, check formulas that prove the constraints, a recommendation in Google Docs and a separate Share_View file shared view-only

1 Optimise	2 Compare	3 Verify	4 Recommend	5 Share safely

Tools: Google Sheets · Gemini optimisation problem solver · Export to Docs · Drive files as context · sharing · OrchidBay_Hiring_Decision.xlsx

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Sample Prompts — Lab 12

	PROMPT	WHAT IT DOES
1	**Optimise:** What is the highest total Weighted_Score possible if the budget is reduced by S$2,000?	A sensitivity test: re-run the optimisation with a tighter budget.
2	**Optimise:** Schedule the eight final interviews across Monday and Tuesday so no interviewer has more than three in a row.	A scheduling problem - another kind of optimisation.
3	**Docs:** Turn the recommendation into a one-page memo with a table of hires and start dates.	Reformats the recommendation for a client audience.
4	**Gmail:** Catch me up on the latest emails about the Q3 hiring drive.	Gemini can reference your Gmail (if enabled) - check the Sources it lists.
5	**Share:** Which tabs in this spreadsheet would be risky to share outside Orchid Bay, and why?	A data-sharing review before you click Share.

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Check Your Results — Lab 12

1

Optimum

CAN-26567, CAN-26608, CAN-26621, CAN-26627, CAN-26683, CAN-26692, CAN-26699, CAN-26711.

2

Totals

Total score 673.5; total salary S$40,700 (budget S$41,900); Within budget = TRUE.

3

Per role

Two Selected per role; All hires = 8.

4

No-budget comparison

674.5 for S$43,100; swap CAN-26622 -> CAN-26627.

5

Share safely

Recommendation exported to Docs; Share_View has 4 columns and 8 candidate rows (plus a header); only the copied Share_View file is shared, as Viewer.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Interactive Dashboard

1. LO3 · KPI formulas: Dropdown selectors drive COUNTIFS and AVERAGEIFS KPIs and summary tables.

2. LO3 · Interactivity: Linked charts, a metric switch, KPI alerts and protection - tested on three views.

3. LO3 · Gems: A Candidate Screener Gem with instructions and knowledge files, used from the Sheets side panel.

4. LO3 · Decide and share: Optimised hires within budget, proved with formulas, exported and shared minimally.

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved

1

Sheets Fundamentals

Use Gemini in Google Sheets - the side panel, actions and formula help - to summarise, quality-check and prepare HR data, and to generate, explain and fix formulas such as VLOOKUP, COUNTIF and nested IF.

2

Analytics & Visualization

Create colour-coded tables, trackers and dropdowns, extract and categorise text with the AI function, and generate data analysis, insights, pivot tables and charts with Gemini, verifying every result.

3

Interactive Dashboard

Build an interactive hiring dashboard, automate repeat screening with a custom Gem, and use Gemini's optimisation solver, reporting and sharing features responsibly.

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NEXT STEPS

Keep the Verified Workflow

1. Use Gemini on one real spreadsheet task this week - and check it with a formula.
2. Turn one monthly report into an interactive dashboard driven by dropdowns.
3. Create one Gem for a task you repeat, with fair, evidence-only instructions.
4. Keep people decisions with accountable people: Gemini drafts, formulas prove, people decide.

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Keep Practising After the Course

1. Re-run the labs on your own machine — repetition is what makes the skills stick.
2. Apply the techniques to a real process or project in your own organisation.
3. Keep your downloaded C817 course files and use the lab checkpoints to restart safely.
4. Explore the follow-on courses at www.tertiarycourses.com.sg.

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Thank You!

You can now use Gemini in Google Sheets to clean, analyse and visualise data, build interactive dashboards and reusable Gems - while keeping evidence, privacy and human judgement in control.

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